A BRIEF HISTORY OF IRELAND

Today, Ireland is a country with a bright future. In 2005,"Economist" magazine selected it as the best place in the world to live. Hundreds of thousands of people from all over the world share that opinion and have moved there in the last decade. But this optimistic outlook was not always the case. Ireland has a long, often bloody and tragic history.

Ireland was first settled around the year 8000 BC, when hunter-gatherers came from Great Britain and Europe, possibly by land bridge. They lived by hunting and fishing for about four thousand years. Around 4000 BC they began to farm, and the old hunter-gatherer lifestyle gradually died out. The descendants[1] of these original settlers built burial mounds and impressive monuments such as Ireland's most famous prehistoric site, Newgrange. Newgrange is a stone tomb[2] dated to sometime before 3000 BC: older than the pyramids in Egypt.

Early Irish society was organized into a number of kingdoms, with a rich culture, a learned upper class, and artisans[3] who created elaborate and beautiful metalwork with bronze, iron, and gold.

Irish society was pagan[4] for thousands of years. This changed in the early fifth century AD, when Christian missionaries, including the legendary St. Patrick, arrived. Christianity replaced the old pagan religions by the year 600. The early monks introduced the Roman alphabet to what had been largely an oral culture. They wrote down part of the rich collection of traditional stories, legends and mythology that might have otherwise been lost.

Two centuries later, from the early ninth century AD, Vikings invaded Ireland. These attacks went on for over 100 years. At first the Vikings raided[5] monasteries and villages. Eventually, they built settlements on the island, many of which grew into important towns. Irish cities founded by the Viking invaders include Dublin, the capital city of the Republic of Ireland, as well as Limerick, Cork, and Wexford. Irish society eventually assimilated the descendants of the Vikings.

The year 1169 saw another invasion that had severe[6] consequences for the island. An invasion of Norman mercenaries marked the beginning of more than seven centuries of Norman and English rule in Ireland. The Norman/English control over Ireland was expanded until the beginning of the 13th century, when the new rulers began to be assimilated into Irish society, as had the Vikings before them.

The Reformation brought this time of relative peace to a brutal end. Beginning in 1534, military campaigns put down Irish chiefs[7] who would not submit[8] to the English king. People were massacred. A policy of "plantations" began: land was confiscated from Catholic Irish landowners, and given to Protestant settlers from England and Scotland. During the next century and a half, Catholic Ireland was conquered, and religion became a source of division and strife[9], a role it held until recent times.

During the 18th century, many laws were passed that discriminated against Catholics. The native Gaelic language was banned in schools. By 1778, only five percent of the land was owned by

[1] a person who is related to you and who lives after you, such as your child or grandchild
[2] a large stone structure or underground room where someone, especially an important person, is buried
[3] someone who does skilled work with their hands
[4] belonging or relating to a religion that worships many gods, especially one that existed before the main world religions
[5] to enter a place illegally and usually violently, and steal from it
[6] very serious
[7] the ruler of a tribe
[8] to allow another person or group to have power or authority over you, or to accept something unwillingly
[9] angry disagreement or violent actions

Catholics. In 1801, the Irish parliament was abolished and Ireland became part of "the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland". Catholics could not hold parliamentary office until 1829.
Poverty was widespread. For many Irish, potatoes were the most important food. In 1845, disaster struck: the potato blight[10]. This disease destroyed much of the potato crop for the next few years. The cause of the blight was not immediately understood, and the English rulers did little to help the situation.
About a million people died of starvation or disease. Another million emigrated to escape poverty and starvation. Because of the potato blight, the population of Ireland fell from more than eight million in 1841 to about six million in 1852.
The population continued to decline more slowly until the second half of the 20th century.
Efforts to gain home rule and improve the condition of the people went on during the 19th century. There were movements for land reform and movements to make Gaelic the official language of Ireland once again. There was strong Protestant opposition to these demands. By 1900, civil war loomed. The Home Rule act was passed in 1914, which would have given Ireland some autonomy, but it was suspended[11] when the first world war started.
There was an uprising on Easter Day, April 24, in 1916. The Easter Uprising failed to spread beyond Dublin, and the leaders were arrested and executed. Their brutal treatment tipped public opinion in favor of independence. The Irish War of Independence began in 1919 and continued until 1921.
In 1922, the southern 26 counties of Ireland seceded from the United Kingdom. The new country called itself the Irish Free State. Gaelic was restored as the official national language, together with English. Ties with Great Britain were cut in 1948. The country became known as the Republic of Ireland. The other six counties in the north of the Ireland, called Northern Ireland, remained part of the UK, which they still are today.
This did not end the conflict. There was sectarian[12] conflict in Northern Ireland, between Nationalists, largely Catholics, who wanted Northern Ireland to unite with the Irish Republic, and the Unionists, mostly Protestants, who were loyal to Great Britain. This unrest exploded violently in the late 1960s, a time called the Troubles. It did not end until 1998, when a peace agreement was signed.
Economically, things slowly began to look up for the Irish after the establishment of the Irish Republic. The economy began to grow in the late 1950s. The population began to increase for the first time since the potato blight, but even today it has not yet re-attained[13] its 1841 level.
Ireland joined the EEC (now the European Union) in 1973. Membership did much to improve the Irish economy, both through direct aid and by increasing foreign investment there. The Irish economy boomed in the 1990s [...]
After centuries of poverty and suffering, Ireland is now a prosperous, modern country with much to offer the world.

[10] a disease that damages and kills plants
[11] stopped
[12] relating to a sect, or happening between sects
[13] reach

Circle the best answer to the questions on the Republic of Ireland.

1. How long ago was Ireland first settled?
a. 100,000 years ago
b. 10,000 years ago
c. 8,000 years ago
d. 1,000 years ago

2. What traces remain of the early inhabitants of Ireland?
a. They left no traces.
b. spears and boats
c. burial mounds & monuments
d. cave paintings

3. What was the original religion in Ireland?
a. Paganism
b. Christianity
c. Judaism
d. No one knows

4. Who brought the Roman alphabet to Ireland?
a. hunter-gatherers
b. Romans
c. Viking invaders
d. Christian missionaries

5. How long did the Viking invasions of Ireland last?
a. a decade
b. a century
c. two centuries
d. a millennium

6. Which Irish cities were built by the Vikings?
a. Limerick
b. Cork and Wexford
c. Dublin
d. All of the above

7. Who invaded Ireland in 1169?
a. hunter-gatherers
b. Christian missionaries
c. Vikings
d. Normans

8. What was a source of conflict in Ireland for centuries?
a. religion
b. literature
c. history
d. all of the above

9. When was Ireland made part of the United Kingdom?
a. 1534
b. 1801
c. 1916
d. 1948

1. What country shares a border with the Republic of Ireland?

_____

2. What is the capital city of the Republic of Ireland?

_____

3. Throughout Irish history there were three major groups of people that came across to the island. What were the groups and about when did they start moving to Ireland?

_____

_____

_____

4. Who first wrote down the early legends and oral culture of Ireland?

_____

5. What eventually happened to the Vikings in Ireland?

_____

6. What was “plantation policy”?

_____

_____

7. When was the Easter Uprising and what effect did it have on Irish independence?

_____

_____

_____

8. Did independence end the conflict everywhere on the island of Ireland?

_____

_____

_____

9. What are the official languages of Ireland?

_____

Prepare a timeline of the most important historic events that were named in the text.

Irish Identity and Emigration

James Joyce was a groundbreaking Irish novelist short story collection Dubliners describes the life of everyday people in Dublin before World War I.

James Joyce - Eveline



She sat at the window watching the evening invade the avenue. Her head was leaned against the window curtains and in her nostrils was the odour of dusty cretonne. She was tired.

Few people passed. The man out of the last house passed on his way home; she heard his footsteps clacking along the concrete pavement and afterwards crunching on the cinder path before the new red houses. One time there used to be a field there in which they used to play every evening with other people's children. Then a man from Belfast bought the field and built houses in it—not like their little brown houses but bright brick houses with shining roofs. The children of the avenue used to play together in that field—the Devines, the Waters, the Dunns, little Keogh the cripple, she and her brothers and sisters. Ernest, however, never played: he was too grown up. Her father used often to hunt them in out of the field with his blackthorn stick; but usually little Keogh used to keep nix and call out when he saw her father coming. Still they seemed to have been rather happy then. Her father was not so bad then; and besides, her mother was alive. That was a long time ago; she and her brothers and sisters were all grown up her mother was dead. Tizzie Dunn was dead, too, and the Waters had gone back to England. Everything changes. Now she was going to go away like the others, to leave her home.

Audiobook

Home! She looked round the room, reviewing all its familiar objects which she had dusted once a week for so many years, wondering where on earth all the dust came from. Perhaps she would never see again those familiar objects from which she had never dreamed of being divided. And yet during all those years she had never found out the name of the priest whose yellowing photograph hung on the wall above the broken harmonium beside the coloured print of the promises made to Blessed Margaret Mary Alacoque. He had been a school friend of her father. Whenever he showed the photograph to a visitor her father used to pass it with a casual word:

"He is in Melbourne now."

She had consented to go away, to leave her home. Was that wise? She tried to weigh each side of the question. In her home anyway she had shelter and food; she had those whom she had known all her life about her. Of course she had to work hard, both in the house and at business. What would they say of her in the stores when they found out that she had run away with a fellow? Say she was a fool, perhaps; and her place would be filled up by advertisement. Miss Gavan would be glad. She had always had an edge on her, especially whenever there were people listening. "Miss Hill, don't you see these ladies are waiting?" "Look lively, Miss Hill, please." She would not cry many tears at leaving the Stores. But in her new home, in a distant unknown country, it would not be like that. Then she would be married—she, Eveline. People would treat her with respect then. She would not be treated as her mother had been. Even now, though she was over nineteen, she sometimes felt herself in danger of her father's violence. She knew it was that that had given her the palpitations. When they were growing up he had never gone for her like he used to go for Harry and Ernest, because she was a girl (...)

1. **Comprehension:** Outline the problems and expectations of the protagonist.
2. **Analysis:** Analyze the protagonist's reaction for staying and for leaving.
3. **Creative Task:** Write an ending for the story.

The Celtic Tiger

At the turn of the 1990s and 2000s, Ireland was able to carry out a phenomenal modernization of its economy.

Ireland got the nickname "Celtic tiger" back in 1994 when Morgan Stanley's economist Kevin Gardner noted the high economic growth rates in this country, comparable with those of East Asian tigers (South Korea, Singapore, Hong-Kong and Taiwan whos economies were developing at a high pace during the '80s and the first half of '90s). The period of rapid growth, low inflation and declining unemployment in the late 1990s was called the "Irish Economic Miracle". The country has changed beyond recognition, it has not only surpassed Britain in terms of per capita income — its neighbour and the former metropolis, but also almost all other European countries. For centuries, Ireland was a poor outback, whose population massively emigrated in search of a better life overseas, but by the beginning of the 2000s, it had turned into a lodestone for migrants. Descendants of Irish emigrants from the United States or Australia and migrants from European countries, from Poland to Spain, both started to reach Dublin.[...]

Tiger jump



From 1994 to 2000, Ireland's GDP growth rates ranged from 6 to 11%, and from 2003 to 2007, the average growth was 5%. During this period, the standard of living in the country not only exceeded the indicator of the former metropolis — Britain but also grew to one of the highest in Europe. In terms of GDP per capita in 2007, Ireland was second only to Luxembourg in the EU (this indicator grew from 67% of the EU average to 111%). Ireland from the poorest countries has become one of the richest.

Revenue growth led to a consumer boom that sparked a spike in the real estate market (partly due to the low-interest rates of the European Central Bank — in 1999, Ireland entered the eurozone). Unemployment fell from almost 20% in the late 1980s to 3.5% in 2007, and salaries were growing at one of the fastest rates in Europe. By the end of the boom, inflation reached 5% per year, which raised prices in the country to the Scandinavian level, although salaries were comparable with the British ones. At the same time, the level of government debt remained at approximately the same level during the growth marathon. And the share of public debt to GDP decreased due to the sharp growth of the economy.

Unexpected wealth led to serious investment and modernization of the infrastructure and cities of Ireland. Roads began to be laid in the country, a suburban railway system was created, tunnels were built. In Dublin, whose population is close to a million, started the construction of the metro system (essentially a light rail), the first in the country.

Economic growth, low unemployment and a high standard of living have changed the trend of centuries-old emigration: Ireland has become a magnet for immigration. This significantly changed the country's demographic outlook and led to the emergence of a multicultural society, especially in Dublin and other major cities. According to some estimates, in 1997 10% of the

population was born in other countries. Some of the new migrants were Irish who emigrated from the country during the years of economic difficulties or their descendants — the Irish diaspora today has 60 million people in the United States, Britain, Canada, Australia, New Zealand and South Africa. However, a significant proportion of migrants came from other European countries, especially Eastern Europe. Ireland was one of the three countries of the "old EU" (along with Britain and Sweden), which in May 2004 opened its labour market to eastern European countries that joined the EU. As a result, tens, and then hundreds of thousands of citizens of Poland and the Baltic countries moved here, many found work in the service sector or construction. But even inside Ireland, active migrations unexpectedly began. Young people began to leave rural areas and look for work in cities. The development of the economy and increased mobility of the population led to an increase in entrepreneurship and an appetite for risks — these qualities did not appear earlier, during periods of economic stagnation. This added dynamism to the economy, although it had little effect on exports — 93% of it was accounted for foreign companies. The success of the "Celtic tiger" at the beginning of this decade turned out to be so great that neighbours gathered to repeat it. In 2005, Scottish nationalist leader Alex Salmond said that Scotland should become independent of London and repeat the Irish experience, becoming a "Celtic lion" (the lion is the heraldic symbol of Scotland). The difference in economic welfare between Britain and Ireland was so high that it began to threaten the unity of the United Kingdom.

The tiger is exhausted

However, since the crisis began in 2007, the economic situation in Ireland has changed dramatically. Foreign investment went down due to the country's loss of competitiveness — the salaries of Irish workers became too high, especially in Dublin and the surrounding area. Partly to blame for the strengthening of the euro against USD and the GBP. Some companies, such as Dell, chose to close their plants and move them to Poland. The real estate bubble was blown away: the Irish, who borrowed the value of their homes for bail, were not as wealthy as they thought. At the beginning of 2008, Ireland entered a recession, which led to a sharp increase in unemployment (increased from 5% in 2007 up to 15% in 2012). Poles and Lithuanians began to leave the Emerald Isle, and even some Irish people thought about emigrating to Australia or Canada, where the depth of the crisis wasn't so severe.

In the fall of 2008, at the peak of the banking crisis after the bankruptcy of Lehman Brothers, Irish banks were on the edge of collapse. The banking system was saved only by the fact that the government gave guarantees on the bank accounts of citizens.

After the crisis

There are not many countries on our planet that are capable of achieving economic growth of almost 8 per cent. Even China, last year, managed to increase its GDP "only" by 6.6 per cent and in the coming years expects to stay at this level at best. But in the northwestern of Europe, there is a state with a population of 4.9 million people and comparable in the territory with the Leningrad oblast (it's where Saint-Petersburg, Russia), which was able to make such a breakthrough. Moreover, if in China the economic dynamics slowed in 2014, then in Ireland, on the contrary, it was growing. As a result, the recovered "Celtic tiger" overtook a somewhat out of breath "Chinese dragon".

Austerity and business model have proven their effectiveness. In autumn 2010, Ireland became the second Eurozone country after Greece, which received emergency multi-billion financial

assistance from the creditors — the European Union (EU), the European Central Bank (ECB) and the International Monetary Fund (IMF).

The successful recovery of the Irish economy is thus confirmed by the correctness and effectiveness of the austerity measures and reform programs, which the European Stabilization Fund and the IMF insist on implementing when they allocate the funds. Following Ireland, various types for such a program were implemented in Portugal, Spain and Cyprus. It did not give the desired result so far only in Greece.

A society capable of reform

A remarkable example of this statement is the decision taken in 2011 at the request of the IMF to gradually increase the retirement age from 65 to 68 years. Society took that decision surprisingly well, there was no explosion of indignation at all. “The Irish do not like to sit back. They tell themselves: if life expectancy increases, then working longer is completely normal, ”explains Edgar Morgenroth, Irish professor at the Institute for Economic and Social Research in Dublin (ESRI)

A country with medicine production and software development. Once a classic agricultural country famous for butter, beer and whiskey, Ireland, after joining the European Union in 1973 and a large-scale reform of the education system, managed to get on an industrial path, focusing on high-tech industries and advanced technologies. So, today the pharmaceutical industry is the largest contributor to the Irish economy, providing almost 60 per cent of exports. As well as the IT industry, especially the American one, has become one of the most important employers on the island.

The computer giant Intel produces microchips in Ireland; also you can find here the European headquarters of Microsoft, Facebook, Google, Twitter, Linkedin. While Apple has already created about 6 thousand jobs on the island. Irland’s competitive advantage is not only a very low corporate tax rate of 12.5 per cent, which Dublin managed to defend in negotiations with the IMF and ECB. A favourable investment climate is also facilitated by excellent transport infrastructure, created mostly with the help of financial support provided by the EU, a large number of qualified personnel, a low level of corruption and efficient government performance. And also, let’s not forget the fact that Ireland is the only eurozone country with English as the official language.

What’s happening now

Today Ireland is fighting coronavirus as well as the rest of the world. Also, there are some local issues like the Irish sea border negotiations with the UK. Since Brexit came into force, the Irish border became the stumbling block between Brussels and London. The negotiation is centred around the question of which side will carry the cost of customs procedures for the years to come. Nevertheless, “Celtic tiger” is in winning position, as many British companies have already moved HQ to Ireland to continue business activity with Eurozone.

https://petrvysotskiy.medium.com/celtic-tiger-20d3eb498a2c 14/03/2021

PRESENTATION

1. Summarize the text on a poster. Focus on the development of Ireland’s economy and explain the concept of the “Celtic Tiger”.

Irish mother and baby homes: Timeline of controversy

The findings of a major investigation into how women and children were treated in Irish mother and baby homes are due to be published.



The investigation began in 2015 after claims emerged that hundreds of babies were buried in a mass, unmarked grave near a home in Tuam, County Galway.

The "Tuam babies" controversy, as it became known, sparked international shock and outrage.

It prompted the Irish government to set up a wide-ranging investigation into the operation of mother and baby homes, in a bid to shed light on the lives and deaths of thousands of former residents.

The institutions mainly housed women who became pregnant outside marriage, which was widely viewed as shameful and socially unacceptable throughout most of the 20th Century in Ireland.

Ahead of the final report, BBC News NI looks back at the timeline of the Tuam babies scandal.

1925

A former workhouse in Tuam, County Galway, which housed destitute adults and children since the famine era, is converted into a mother and baby home.

It is owned by Galway County Council, but is run by an order of Catholic nuns - the Bon Secours Sisters.

Tuam Home Graveyard Committee

The Tuam mother and and baby home was run by nuns between 1925 and 1961

For the next 36 years, it houses unmarried mothers and their children during a period when women were ostracised by Irish society and often by their own families if they became pregnant outside marriage.



It was just one of several similar institutions in which about 35,000 single mothers gave birth.

Conditions in Tuam were particularly difficult and research would later show that on average, a child from the home died every two weeks between 1925 and 1961.

1961

Having fallen into a dilapidated state, the Tuam mother and baby home is shut and its remaining residents are transferred to similar homes around the country.

1972

Following demolition of the Tuam home, construction work begins to create a new council-owned housing estate in the area.

1975

Two young boys discover skeletal remains in a concrete structure while playing near the site of the former home.

Locals assume it is a famine-era grave and a priest is called to bless the site before the structure is re-sealed.

Following the incident, residents treat the site as an old burial ground, eventually erecting a memorial garden with a Catholic shrine.

2012

After years of research into the history of the Tuam mother and baby home, amateur historian Catherine Corless publishes an article entitled "The Home" in a local history journal.



Tuam woman Catherine Corless was instrumental in exposing the secret burials

She details the poor living conditions inside the institution and states that a "staggering number of children lost their lives in the home" between 1925 and 1961, mainly due to various diseases.

Ms Corless acknowledges the deaths took place during a period when Ireland had a "very high infant mortality rate" but she questions why there are no records of where the Tuam babies were buried.

September 2013



Ms Corless completes a personal mission to collate the death certificates of 798 children who died at the Tuam home. In all but two cases, she cannot trace their burial records.

Catherine Corless collated hundreds of death certificates for the infants who died in the home

February 2014

The Connacht Tribune publishes an interview with Ms Corless about her campaign for a permanent memorial for the Tuam babies, including a plaque displaying all 796 infants' names.

May 2014

The Irish Mail on Sunday publishes a story claiming there are fears up to 800 babies were secretly buried in a "mass grave" at the home in Tuam. This time the story gains international attention.

June 2014

Following weeks of speculation over the fate of the Tuam babies, the Irish government orders a nationwide commission of investigation into Ireland's mother and baby homes.

Announcing the move, the then Taoiseach (Prime Minister) Enda Kenny says babies born to unmarried parents were treated as "an inferior sub-species" for decades in the Republic of Ireland.

January 2015

Under its terms of reference, the commission is tasked with investigating practices in Irish mother and baby homes over a 76-year period, from the foundation of the state in 1922 through to 1998.

The panel is asked to examine the living conditions in the homes as well as mortality

rates; general causes of death among residents, burial arrangements and participation in vaccine trials.

They were also tasked with investigating adoption processes in the homes, including whether or not birth mothers were able to give "full, free and informed" consent for their children to be adopted.

October 2016

The commission of investigation begins test excavations at the site of the former mother and baby home in Tuam.



Ground surveys were carried out at the site before the excavation took place

4 March 2017

The commission confirms that "significant quantities of human remains" have been found during excavations at the site in Tuam and says it is "shocked" by the discovery.

Tests on a small number of remains establish that they were children ranging in age from premature babies to three-year-old toddlers, all of whom died while the mother and baby home was in operation.

The remains were found in a large underground "structure" which was divided into 20 chambers.

The commission says the structure "appears to be related" to the treatment or storage of sewage or waste water but adds it has not yet established if it was ever used for that purpose.

7 March 2017

Taoiseach Enda Kenny describes the burial site as a "chamber of horrors".

He says he will await further work from the commission, coroner, and Gardaí (police) before deciding how to proceed.

February 2018



Nuns and children at Bessborough House in Cork, where more than 900 children died

The commission appeals to the public for information about the burials of a "large number of children who died while resident" in Bessborough mother and baby home in Cork.

April 2018

Catherine Corless is among those honored at Ireland's People of the Year Awards - just one of several high-profile honors she receives for her work to uncover the truth about the Tuam burials.

October 2018

Minister for Children Katherine Zappone announces plans for a forensic excavation of the Tuam site, saying the remains of each child will be exhumed, identified and given a "respectful" reburial.

March 2019

The commission outlines its conclusions on burial arrangements at the homes in its fifth interim report.

Its report states that a total of 802 children died inside the Tuam home during its 36 years in operation.

In addition, 12 mothers died while resident at the home, the majority from childbirth complications.

The commission says the human remains it found in 2016/2017 "are not in a sewage tank, but in a second structure with 20 chambers which was built within the decommissioned large sewage tank".

The report says the precise purpose of the chamber structure has still not been established, but it is "likely to be related to the treatment/containment of sewage and/or waste water".

The commission dates this second structure to about 1937 and says: "It seems clear that many of the children who died in the Tuam Home are buried in the chambers described."

It also dismisses theories that the structure may have been purpose-built burial chamber or crypt, saying it "did not provide for the dignified interment of human remains".

The report adds it has not been possible to establish who physically buried the infants but it "seems likely that the burials were conducted on the instructions" of the Bon Secours Sisters.

The nuns' representative had already told the inquiry that the order was "shocked and devastated" by the revelations and apologized "unreservedly" for the failure to provide proper burials.

Separately, the fifth report states that more than 900 children died while resident at Bessborough mother and baby home in Cork, but it is still not known where the vast majority are buried.

Despite "very extensive inquiries and searches", the commission says it has established the burial place of only 64 of these children.

October 2020

Former residents raise concerns over a new law which they fear could block access to much of the information collected by the commission.

Their campaign warns that many documents could be sealed in national archives for 30 years.



Campaigners held a protest in Dublin over future access to the commission's records

However, the government insists that "urgent legislation" is required to protect the information from having to be destroyed or redacted when the commission is legally dissolved after its final report.

Minister for Children Roderic O'Gorman explains that the commission has developed databases which could assist family tracing services, but because they contain sensitive personal information, the commission felt obliged to redact "identifying" details from its databases before transfer.

The minister says the new legislation allows a copy of the databases to be given to the child and family agency Tusla to assist family tracing, while the "main archive" can be deposited in line with the 2004 legislation under which the commission was set up.

The bill is fast-tracked through the Dáil (Irish parliament), infuriating former residents.

25 October 2020

Irish President Michael D Higgins signs the bill on mother and baby home records into law.

He notes that the bill raised important concerns "which must be addressed" but he concludes that it does not require referral to the Supreme Court for judgement on its constitutionality.

However, a statement from the president's office says his decision to sign this legislation "leaves it open to any citizen to challenge the provisions of the bill in the future".

10 January 2021

Details of the inquiry's final report is leaked to a newspaper days before publication, angering campaigners and government ministers.

12 January 2021

The publication of the final report of the inquiry into mother and baby homes is described as a "landmark moment for the Irish state".

The government says it will issue an apology over the "appalling level of infant mortality" identified in the report.

The inquiry concludes that about 9,000 children died in the 18 institutions under investigation - about 15% of all the children who lived in the homes.

The commission makes 53 recommendations, including compensation and memorialization.

An umbrella group representing survivors of Mother and Baby Homes say they have "mixed feelings about the long overdue report".
The Coalition of Mother and Baby Home Survivors says: "This report is fundamentally incomplete as it ignores the larger issue of the forced separation of single mothers and their babies since the foundation of the state as a matter of state policy."

13 January 2021

In response to the final report, the Sisters of Bon Secours offer their "profound apologies" to all the women and children who lived at the Tuam home, their families and to the people of Ireland.
The order admitted its nuns "did not live up to our Christianity when running the home".
"We acknowledge in particular that infants and children who died at the home were buried in a disrespectful and unacceptable way. For all that, we are deeply sorry," the sisters added.
Their spokesman confirmed that the order will take part in a redress scheme.
Later the Taoiseach (Irish Prime Minister) Mícheál Martin issues a formal apology to former residents of mother and baby homes on behalf of the state.
In a statement to the Dáil (Irish parliament), he says a "profound generational wrong" had been visited on women and children who were sent to the institutions.
"We had a completely warped attitude to sexuality and intimacy, and young mothers and their sons and daughters were forced to pay a terrible price for that dysfunction," the Taoiseach said.

1. Summarize the text an look up all unknown vocabulary.

2. Your stupid English teacher is unable to understand your summary. Translate the most important facts to good old German.

Is there a future for the Catholic Church in Ireland?

October 19 2019 12:00 AM

Betrayal by Silence, the Collapse of the Irish Catholic Church – has it a Future? is the title of a book by a former priest, Tony O'Dwyer who spends much of his time in Sligo and who had a launch for his work here.

At the launch in the Yeats Building, former MEP[14] Marian Harkin has described it as a must read for anyone interested in the history of the catholic church in Ireland and how it can survive into the future. In his own words, the author outlines, "As a young man I worked for ten years as a missionary in the Philippines. In 1973, I departed the Philippines and the priesthood. On my return to Ireland, I was recruited[15] by the Agency for Personal Service Overseas to provide training to Irish overseas development workers and missionaries (eventually 10,000) to enable them to account[16] for the government's and donors' finances. Years later, I was deeply disturbed by the child abuse Inquiries. The Inquiries coincided[17] with my retirement and the opportunity, over the next nine years, to wrestle with the question [...] the Irish Catholic Church - has it a Future? I traced the growth of the church from Constantine's Edict of Milan[18], 313 AD, when the persecuted community emerged from the catacombs to become the powerful institution we experienced in 20th Century Ireland. By 1967, on a per capita basis, the Irish Church became the most powerful in the world. It had obtained[19] from the state, formidable[20] constitutional powers and had recruited from proud parents, 34,000 of their sons and daughters into the religious life, (26,000 home based and 8,000 overseas). To promote its religion, the church took control of the state's health, education and welfare services through its religious, who were paid an income of €1 billion p.a.[21], in current values. [...] Overburdened by its power, the church lacked the flexibility to respond to the late 20th century consumerist challenges and went into a decline. Between 1966 and 1970, annual vocations[22] halved, from 1,409 to 750, while in the decade, 1970 to 1980, 3,000 religious departed the religious life. The church's determined prohibitions of the pill, divorce, abortion and same sex marriage are now, equally determined by the people, enshrined[23] in the Irish Constitution.

Ten years ago, the church collapsed when government Inquiries revealed[24] widespread clerical and institutional abuses of children along with the cover up of the abuses by church leaders. In response, bishops and religious withdrew to their palaces, presbyteries[25] and institutions, sheltering from the blitz of outrage from a scandalised people. The religious complained that they, unfairly, had to bear the brunt of that anger, and rightly, pointed to the neglect of the children by ministers, civil servants and citizenry. Such sentiments overlook a key feature of the scandals. The cover up[26] of the abuses was buried deep in the church's laws and bishops' psyches. When Pope Pius X decreed in 1909, that

[14] Member of the European Parliament
[15] to persuade someone to work for a company
[16] to provide a report on money received, kept, and spent
[17] to happen at or near the same time
[18] **Edict of Milan**, proclamation that permanently established religious toleration for Christianity within the Roman Empire. It was the outcome of a political agreement concluded in Mediolanum (modern **Milan**) between the Roman emperors Constantine I and Licinius in February 313
[19] get
[20] inspiring respect through being impressively large, powerful, intense, or capable
[21] a year
[22] an entry into priesthood or a religious order
[23] protected
[24] to make known or show something that is surprising or that was previously secret
[25] the house of a Roman Catholic parish priest.
[26] an attempt to prevent the public from discovering information about a serious crime or mistake

every five years the world's bishops make their secret ad limina[27] reports on the state of their dioceses to the pope, he had to be aware that such secrecy would not eliminate the perennial[28] clerical child abuse crimes from the church. The Decree merely buried the abuses deep in episcopal safes for 80 years, until the 1990s, when journalists uncovered the sufferings of abused victims. [...] If the bishops had publicly accounted for[29] their use of the resources, the abuses would, long since, have been exposed and the children protected. [...] However, the church, the biggest employer in Ireland, was riven[30] with incompetence in management, leadership and communications, all traceable to the avoidance of accountability.

While the Charities Acts and the National Board for Safeguarding Children (NBSCCCI) have made redundant[31] many of the ad limina report obligations, the religious leaders dare not return to their secret habits, but must, as was done to the Irish banks, commission a public investigation into the church's collapse.

Two terrible crimes were committed: the abuses, which have been much investigated, and the cover ups by the bishops, whose investigation has been studiously[32] avoided. This immoral practice is intolerable. Just as the state sought an accounting through its Inquiries, the laity[33] have an obligation to require public audits[34] and evaluations of the resources they contributed to their church. If the leaders refuse, the laity must stop paying until they do. When the leaders make their reports public, the Second Reformation of the church can begin. As free citizens we must break down the powerful walls of secrecy which bishops and popes have built around themselves and their machinations. As Angela Merkel commented, on her recent visit to Dublin: "For 34 years I lived behind the Iron Curtain, so I know only too well what it means when borders vanish and walls fall".

https://www.independent.ie/regionals/sligochampion/is-there-a-future-for-the-catholic-church-in-ireland-38573870.html 20/03/2021



[27] In the Catholic Church, a visit **ad limina** means the obligation of residential diocesan bishops and certain prelates with territorial jurisdiction (of visiting the thresholds of the [tombs of the] Apostles, Saints Peter and Paul, and of meeting the pope to report on the state of their dioceses or prelatures.
[28] lasting or existing for a long or apparently infinite time; enduring or continually recurring
[29] If someone has to **account** for an action or policy, they are responsible for it, and may be required to explain it to other people or be punished if it fails
[30] split or tear apart violently
[31] unnecessary because it is more than is needed
[32] in a way that is very careful and intentional
[33] all the people who are involved with a Church but who are not priests
[34] an official examination